

Nintendo to announce Wii 2 soon

According to reports, Nintendo is finally getting ready to show off the next generation of its popular gaming console in June.

Apple releases Mac OS X 10.6.7 update

The update brings general stability, compatibility and security fixes, and resolves the recent MacBook Pro hard freeze issue.

RIA devs rejoice! Mid-cycle Adobe CS5.5 is out

Adobe has announced an upcoming version of their Creative Suite, CS 5.5 and it promises to bring a number of great features for RIA developers. One of the central themes of this release is to enable creation of content for multiple screens, features for which have been added to Dreamweaver, Flash Professional, Flash Catalyst, and Flash Builder among other applications.

CS5.5 includes updated versions of Dreamweaver and Flash Professions, and includes Flash Builder 4.5 and Catalyst CS5.5. It also brings in the new Adobe Acrobat X into the Creative Suite. Adobe Dreamweaver CS5.5 will support emerging

web standards with HTML5 and CSS3. A new multi-screen preview panel lets web developers design for smartphones, tablets and desktops with greater ease by taking advantages of new standards.

Dreamweaver CS5.5 also allows developers to create content for mobiles with greater ease by adding support for the jQuery Mobile framework. Developers can also directly create applications for mobiles CS5.5 also adds the ability to test such applications on an emulator.

Flash Builder 4.5 brings the new Mobile-optimized Flex 4.5 SDK that supports building applications for Android, iOS and soon the Blackberry PlayBook as well. Numerous



improvements to coding workflow have also been made. Flash Builder now also comes in a new PHP-enhanced version in collaboration with Zend. This includes a copy of Zend Studio allowing for development of server side of your application in tandem with the client application.

Adobe now intends to release new "milestone" releases such as CS3, CS4, CS5 every two years, while having mid-cycle releases in between to bring newer features faster without a major release. This means that CS5.5 is not a free

update to CS5, but is cheaper than a full-fledged CS5 to CS 6 move would have been.

In addition to a new release cycle Adobe is also introducing a new model for using CS applications. A new subscription model allows one pay for using Adobe products on a monthly basis instead of an outright purchase. So freelancers or others who cannot afford Adobe products at their retail prices, or those who only need to use the products for short periods of time can pay a subscription price rather than at the full price of the products. ■

Feasible nanogenerators to power future electronics through motion

A team of scientists lead by Dr. Zhong Lin Wang at the School of Materials Science and Engineering at the Georgia Institute of Technology have developed a feasible nanogenerator that could power electrical devices simply by their movement. The study was funded by a remarkable number of institutions, including the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency, the Department of Energy, the U.S. Air Force, the National Science Foundation and the National Institutes of Health.

According to Dr. Wang, they team has progressed quite a bit from its early days, now offering

power several orders of magnitude higher than before. He added: "This development represents a milestone toward producing portable electronics



Nanogenerator nanowire array

that can be powered by body movements without the use of batteries or electrical outlets.

If we can sustain the rate of improvement, the nanogenerator may find a broad range of other applications that require more power."

years. The nanogenerator, seen above, is a flexible chip made up of millions of zinc oxide nanowire piezoelectric filaments, which generate electricity if stressed, squeezed or bent. The current iteration of the nanogenerator is powerful enough to drive such electronics as liquid crystal displays, light emitter and laser diodes, and sensors. According to Dr. Wang, five of these nanogenerators piled up together can generate nearly 1 microampere of current at 3 volts, roughly the same as two AA batteries.

As you can imagine, the applications are endless, especially in portable devices, from entertainment to medical. Bio-mechanical/electrical prostheses, machines and implantations could also be powered by such nanogenerators. ■